**Huddle** Decision-led development for teams coding with AI

# Your first day with Huddle

You joined a team that works with Claude Code and Huddle. Tasks arrive as Issues with their prompt ready; you start one with a command, answer the AI's questions and decide. This guide sets up your computer once, from zero to your first Issue.

> **The AI writes, tests and asks; you decide.**
> **Your answers to its questions are the work.**

GETTING STARTED

## Your first day, step by step

You do this once. It takes 20 to 40 minutes, mostly waiting for downloads. When a step depends on your computer, there is one block for Windows and another for Mac. Your project may add its own steps (its libraries, its test database): they are in the project's `README` and step 7 points you there.

**Copy each command from its box, whole and on a single line.** If it pastes split in two lines, join it before pressing Enter.

### 1. Choose how you will use Claude Code

Claude Code works the same in all its versions: the same rules, the same `CLAUDE.md` and the same Huddle plugin. Pick the one you find most comfortable; you can switch later.

DESKTOP APP · THE EASIEST

For people who are starting out. You see the changes visually and can have several sessions side by side. Requires a paid Claude plan.

**Install:** follow the Windows or Mac download links at `code.claude.com/docs/en/desktop-quickstart`, sign in and open the **Code** tab.

VS CODE EXTENSION

For people who want to read and edit the code in an editor while working with Claude Code.

**Install:** VS Code from `code.visualstudio.com`; then open the extensions panel (`Ctrl+Shift+X` or `Cmd+Shift+X`), search for **Claude Code** (by Anthropic) and install it. The extension has no `/plugin` command: you install Huddle from a terminal in step 4.

TERMINAL (CLI)

For people who already use the command line. It is also the one that shows Huddle's notice the moment a session opens.

**Install:** on Windows, in PowerShell:

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

On Mac, in Terminal:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Then type `claude` inside the project folder.

## 2. Install Git and your platform's command line

Git keeps the code's history. Huddle talks to your platform through its official command line: `gh` for GitHub, `glab` for GitLab. Install the one your project uses.

WINDOWS

1. **Git:** download «Git for Windows» from `git-scm.com` and install it with the default options. It includes **Git Bash**.

2. **GitHub:** open PowerShell and type:

```
winget install --id GitHub.cli
```

3. **GitLab:**

```
winget install --id GLab.GLab
```

4. Close the terminal and open a new one, so it finds the new programs. In VS Code, close every window and open it again.

MAC

1. **Git:** open Terminal and type (two hyphens before `install`):

```
xcode-select --install
```

2. **Homebrew** (the Mac's program installer): follow the one-line instruction at `brew.sh`.
3. **GitHub:**

```
brew install gh
```

**GitLab:**

```
brew install glab
```

**Check:** in a new terminal, `gh --version` (or `glab --version`) answers with a version number.

### 3. Connect your accounts

**The repository:** accept the invitation that arrives by email. Until you accept it, Huddle cannot assign you Issues.

**GitHub:** type `gh auth login` and choose GitHub.com, HTTPS and «Login with a web browser».

**GitLab:** type `glab auth login`, choose gitlab.com (or your company's server) and sign in with the browser. Then let Git use `glab` for gitlab.com, so a Claude

Code session can push without opening a browser:

```
git config --global --add credential.https://gitlab.com.helper "!glab auth git-credential"
```

**Claude Code:** open it and sign in with the Claude account the AI Manager tells you.

### 4. Install the Huddle plugin

Huddle comes as a Claude Code plugin. Each person installs it once on their own computer; committing it to the repository does not install it for you. In a terminal:

```
claude plugin marketplace add SrProfessional/Huddle
```

```
claude plugin install huddle@huddle
```

Then open a new Claude Code session. In the CLI you can also type `/plugin marketplace add SrProfessional/Huddle` and `/plugin install huddle@huddle` instead.

**Check:** `claude plugin list` shows `huddle@huddle` enabled. To update it later, run `claude plugin marketplace update huddle` and open a new session.

### 5. Set your language (a single message)

Issues come in English, so Claude Code would answer in English unless you set your language. Open a session and send this message, replacing `YOUR_LANGUAGE` with your language written in English (for example `spanish` or `portuguese`):

```
Add "language": "YOUR_LANGUAGE" to my personal Claude Code settings file,
~/.claude/settings.json. Keep everything else in that file as it is.
```

It asks for permission to edit the file: accept it. From then on it answers in your language in every session. Commits, PRs and comments stay in English.

### 6. Download the project and open it

In a terminal, go to the folder where you keep your projects and clone it (the AI Manager gives you its name):

```
gh repo clone OWNER/PROJECT
```

On GitLab: `glab repo clone OWNER/PROJECT`. Then open that folder in the Claude Code you chose. When it asks whether you trust the folder, say yes.

### 7. Do your project's own setup

Every project has its own libraries and tests. Open its `README` (and its `CLAUDE.md`) and follow the setup section, or ask Claude Code: «read the README and install what the project needs, then run the tests and tell me the results».

### 8. Check that Huddle sees everything

Ask Claude Code: «run huddle doctor». Every line must show ✓: `plugin`, `huddle.json`, `login`, `ai_manager` and `labels`. If one shows ✕, its line says what to do; if it is not clear, send it to the AI Manager.

### 9. Take your first Issue

Find the Issue assigned to you (label `assigned`), or type `gh issue list --assignee @me`. In Claude Code type:

```
/huddle-start N
```

with the Issue's number instead of `N`. It checks that the Issue's dependencies are merged, creates your branch in a folder of its own, marks the Issue `in progress` and starts the Issue's prompt. Answer its questions calmly: that is where your work is.

### 10. When the AI Manager asks for changes

You do not need to watch GitHub. After its closing message the session keeps waiting for the review. When the AI Manager leaves a request, the session tells

you and asks whether to continue: say yes. If you had closed Claude Code, open a new session in the project: Huddle tells you that a request is waiting (in the CLI you see the line at once; in the desktop app and the VS Code panel Claude says it after your first message).

RULES

## Five things that are not negotiable

**Never push to the default branch, and never merge.** Only the AI Manager merges.

**Only the Issue's allowed files.** If another one is needed, ask first.

**No production and no secrets.** If a permission or a key is missing, stop and tell the AI Manager.

**Nothing is dropped silently.** What is not done goes under «What was NOT done» with the reason.

**Wait for the closing message.** «✅ Issue #N finished» or «⛔ Issue #N stopped» tells you the session is over and what your next step is.

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Huddle · decision-led development for teams coding with AI · github.com/SrProfessional/Huddle. The full guide (cycle, roles, labels and rules) is `docs/pdf/huddle-guide.pdf`.